

ZHANIBEK DARIMBEK

Applied AI / Agent Engineer

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EXPERIENCE

AI Engineer — Sema US (Remote) Oct 2025 – Aug 2026

Liz — an AI agent answering engineering-org questions (delivery health, process leakage, planning risk) over a company's Jira/Linear, GitHub, Slack and internal documents. Tech lead, 5 engineers; hands-on across design, build and ship.

- Took Liz from a proof of concept over Jira and GitHub to the production system: Slack, Zoom, Teams and document ingestion, hybrid pgvector retrieval, subagents, tool search, context compaction.
- Moved the agent off live Jira/GitHub APIs onto read-only SQL views over a mirrored data layer, so aggregation runs in SQL instead of the model. Cost per run down 52%, wall-clock 68%, score variance halved.
- Replaced model-driven tool calls with code generated and run in a sandbox: multi-MB tool outputs never reach the context window, and aggregation is exact rather than sampled.
- Profiled production runs to find where the agent wasted time and tokens — oversized tool returns, unstable tool parameters on repeat runs, and parallel batches stalled by one slow call (86%).
- Built the privacy enforcement that keeps the product from becoming developer surveillance, at four points in the agent loop. Scrapped my own salted-hash design once the hashes proved re-identifiable.

Senior Software Engineer — Monite Germany (Remote) May 2024 – Oct 2025

- Built accounts-receivable, payments, and accounting-automation APIs for B2B fintech platforms.
- Shipped an AI feature for drafting AR invoices from natural language, using Pydantic AI with tool calling grounded in a company's invoice history; delivered as an API resource and a ready-to-issue PDF.
- Designed a PDF customization engine for AR documents, with dynamic templates, styling, and line-item configuration for partners' branding.
- Rebuilt the Recurring Invoices API with flexible scheduling (weekly, monthly, custom dates), draft/send via email, and pause, cancel, and resend flows.
- Stood up an internal MCP server that pulls context from Notion, Jira, Confluence, and GitHub into one space for coding agents, cutting context switching and ticket-to-deploy time.

CTO — ioka group Almaty, Kazakhstan Nov 2020 – May 2024

Founding engineer; grew to CTO of a fintech and travel ecosystem in Kazakhstan and Uzbekistan.

- Built the payment gateway from scratch and took it to 200+ merchants: talked directly to customers' developers, collected feedback, built custom solutions, and scaled with them.
- Shipped APIs and mobile SDKs for card acquiring, Apple Pay, Google Pay, BNPL, saved cards, subscriptions, P2P, payment links, and payouts.
- Built multi-acquirer orchestration with routing by availability, cost, and payment scheme.
- Led PCI DSS Level 1 certification: worked with QSA assessors, documented architecture and processes, ran scans, applied recommendations, and maintained compliance across quarterly and annual cycles.
- Built ioka Travel's backend with GDS and railway ticket provider integrations, deployed end to end to first customers in Uzbekistan.

Software Engineer — Kazdream Tech Astana, Kazakhstan May 2019 – Nov 2020

- Automated data collection from 20+ social, messaging and web/mobile sources; built crawlers feeding scalable B2B APIs and real-time systems.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

AI / LLM: Multi-agent systems, tool/function calling, sandboxed code execution, hybrid retrieval (pgvector + full-text, RRF), MCP servers, agent guardrails & trajectory analysis; Pydantic AI, provider SDKs (OpenAI / Anthropic / Gemini); familiar: LangChain / LangGraph

Backend: Python (async), FastAPI, Django + DRF, aiohttp, API design

Data & Infra: PostgreSQL (+ pgvector), Redis, RabbitMQ, Temporal, Docker; Logfire / OpenTelemetry, per-request LLM cost accounting

EDUCATION

M.Sc., Data Science — Nazarbayev University, Astana 2020 – 2022

Thesis: Sequential Deep Learning Models for Human Skeleton-based Gait Recognition

B.Sc., Computer Science — Nazarbayev University, Astana 2016 – 2020